About the Poet

Mary Ann Evans (1819 – 1880), known by her pen name George Eliot, was an English novelist, poet, journalist, translator, and one of the leading writers of the Victorian era. She wrote seven novels.


George Eliot

Glossary

grace (n)	-	elegance, charm
aspiration (n)	-	a hope or ambition of achieving something, desire, wish
courage (n)	-	bravery, valour
gleam (n)	-	shine brightly
glimpse (n)	-	glance, quick look
worthwhile (adj)	-	valuable, purposeful
heritage (n)	-	inheritance

1. Comprehension questions.

1. What should we learn from every soul?
2. What qualities will help us brave the thickening ills of life?
3. Why should we make this life worthwhile?
4. What does the poet assure if we make our life worthwhile?

2. Figure of speech.

Repetition:

Repetition is a literary device that repeats the same words of phrases a few times to make an idea clearer and more memorable. It is used to emphasize a feeling or idea, create rhythm, and bring attention to an idea.

The woods are lovely, dark, and deep,
But I have promises to keep
And miles to go before I sleep,
and miles to go before I sleep.

- Robert Frost

Pick out any two lines of repetition from the poem.

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